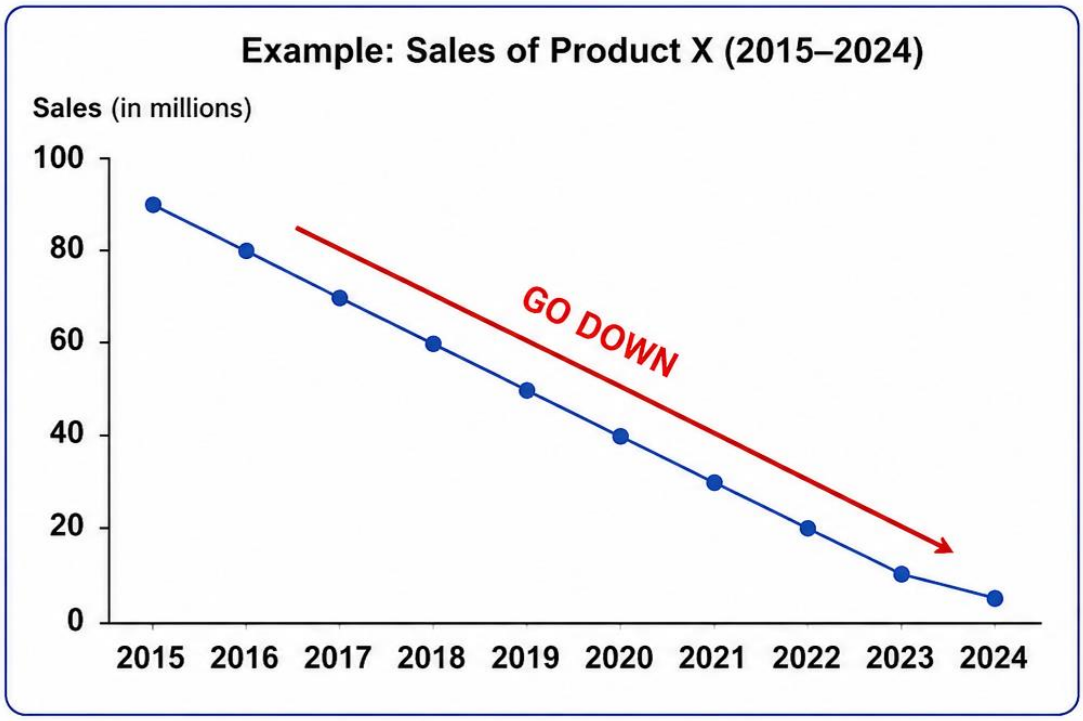
VOCABULARY FOR GRAPH

USEFUL LANGUAGE FOR TASK 1 (WRITING)

GO DOWN – to move from a higher level to a lower level



OTHER VERBS TO EXPRESS "GO DOWN"

1. **decreased** – became smaller or less
2. **fell** – moved down to a lower level
3. **dropped** – fell suddenly or quickly
4. **declined** – became smaller gradually
5. **came down** – reduced or lowered

---

6. **plummet** – fall sharply and quickly
7. **plunge** – drop suddenly and steeply

★ These verbs may also be used as **NOUNS**.
Example: There was a sharp **drop** in profits last year.

- **Go down**

  Example: The sales of Product X went down from 90 million in 2015 to 5 million in 2024.

- **Decrease**

  Example: The sales of Product X decreased steadily over the period.

- **Fall**

  Example: The sales fell significantly between 2018 and 2022.

- **Drop**

  Example: The sales dropped from 40 million to 20 million between 2020 and 2022.

- **Decline**

  Example: The graph illustrates that the sales declined gradually throughout the years.

- **Come down**

  Example: The sales came down sharply after 2021.

- **Plummet**

  Example: The sales plummeted to only 5 million in 2024.

- **Plunge**

  Example: The sales plunged dramatically during the final years of the period.

It is important to note that ***plunge*** and ***plummet*** do not take adverbs of degree. By definition, these verbs convey ***a substantial decrease*** rather than a slight one, as illustrated by the two preceding examples.

We can say "*decreased*
considerably/sharply/dramatically/significantly/substantially".

But we can not say:

"**plummeted**
~~*considerably/sharply/dramatically/significantly/substantially*~~."

Or

“**plunged** ~~*considerably/sharply/dramatically/significantly/substantially*~~.”

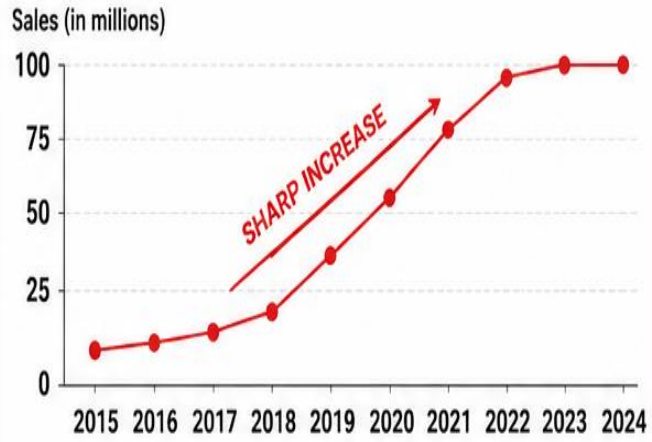
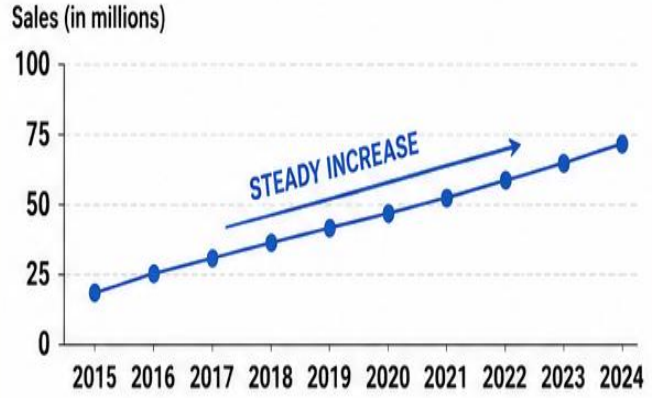
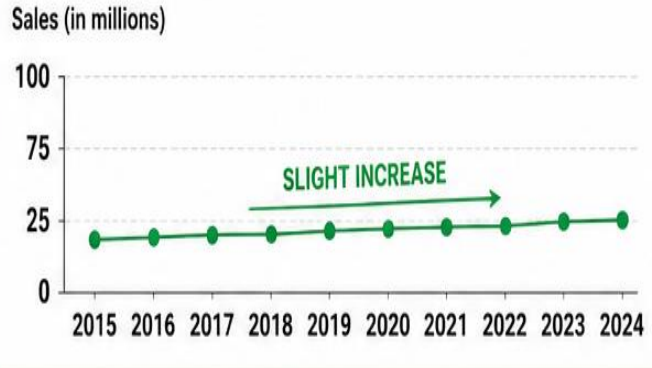
No need to use those two verbs “*plunge*” and “*plummet*” with an adverb. ***Decreased sharply*** equals ***plummeted***. They mean the same thing.

Use of Adjective and Adverb in a Graph

Intensity	Adjectives	Adverbs
Big Change / High Speed	Sharp, Rapid, Quick, Considerable,	Sharply, Rapidly, Quickly, Considerably,

Intensity	Adjectives	Adverbs
	Significant, Substantial	Significantly, Substantially
Medium / Constant Change	Steady, Gradual, Moderate	Steadily, Gradually, Moderately
Small Change / Low Speed	Slight, Slow	Slightly, Slowly

INTENSITY OF CHANGE – IELTS WRITING TASK 1

INTENSITY	GRAPHICAL REPRESENTATION	ADJECTIVES	ADVERBS
BIG CHANGE HIGH SPEED (Large change in a short time)		• Sharp • Rapid • Quick • Considerable • Significant • Substantial	• Sharply • Rapidly • Quickly • Considerably • Significantly • Substantially
MEDIUM / CONSTANT CHANGE (Moderate change over time)		• Steady • Gradual • Moderate	• Steadily • Gradually • Moderately
SMALL CHANGE LOW SPEED (Little change over time)		• Slight • Slow	• Slightly • Slowly

★ USE THESE WORDS TO DESCRIBE HOW DATA CHANGES OVER TIME IN GRAPHS.

Example: Sales increased sharply from 10 million in 2015 to 100 million in 2022.

Examples of Intensity of Change (IELTS Writing Task 1)

Big Change / High Speed:

- "The sales increased **sharply** from 20 million to 90 million between 2017 and 2022."
- "The number of tourists rose **rapidly** over the period."
- "Profits grew **significantly** after 2020."
- "The population experienced a **substantial** increase during the decade."
- "Car sales saw a **considerable** rise in 2021."

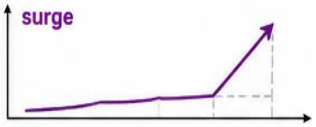
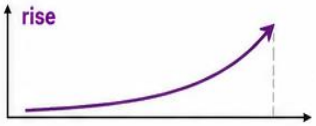
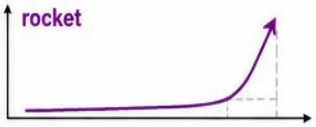
Medium / Constant Change:

- "The unemployment rate increased **steadily** throughout the year."
- "The figure showed a **gradual** rise between 2015 and 2020."
- "Internet usage grew **moderately** over the period."
- "The number of students witnessed a **steady** increase."
- "Exports experienced a **moderate** growth during the first half of the year."

Small Change / Low Speed:

- "The price of fuel increased **slightly** in 2023."
- "The number of visitors rose **slowly** over the period."
- "There was a **slight** increase in electricity consumption."
- "The company's profit grew at a **slow** pace."

VERBS FOR "GO UP" – IELTS WRITING TASK 1

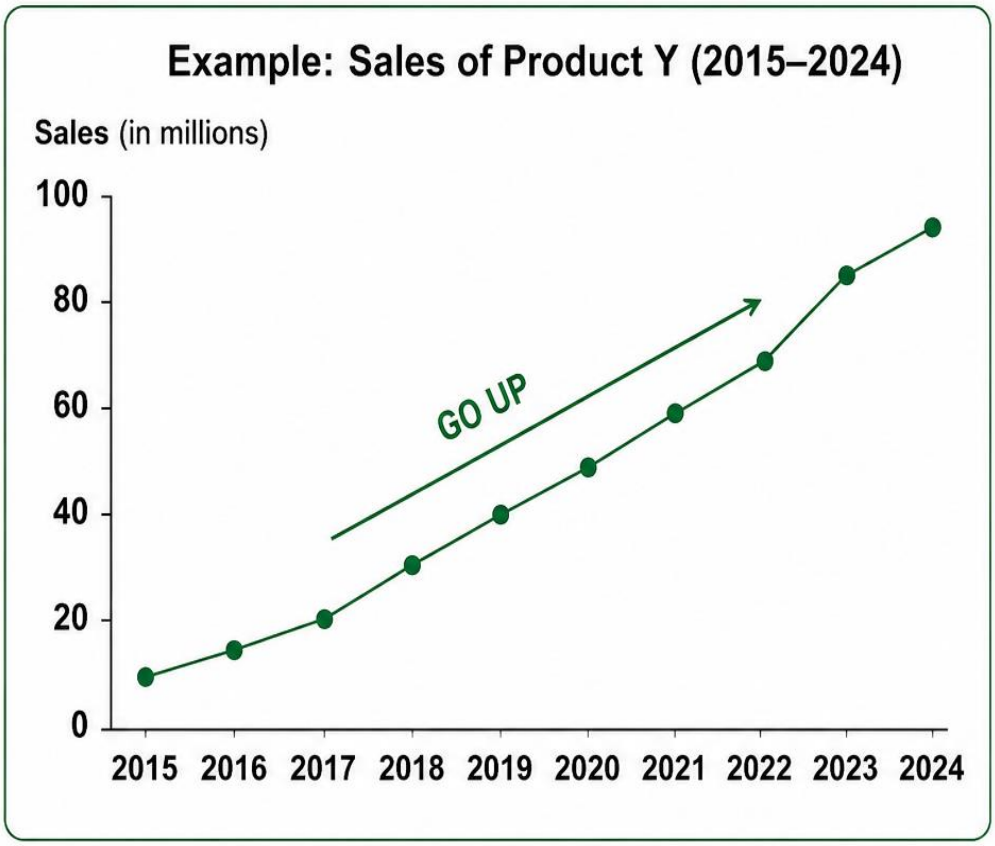
DIRECTION	VERBS	EXAMPLE IN SENTENCE	GRAPHICAL REPRESENTATION	INTENSITY
Go up 	• climb	• Sales **climbed** from 20 million to 80 million in five years.		High
	• surge	• The number of tourists **surged** to over 2 million in 2023.		Very High
	• grow	• The company's profit **grew** steadily over the period.		Medium
	• increase	• The population **increased** from 10,000 to 15,000 in a decade.		Medium
	• jump	• The price of oil **jumped** to $100 per barrel.		High
	• rise	• The demand for apartments **rose** sharply in 2022.		High
	• rocket	• Online sales **rocketed** after the pandemic.		Very High

★ These verbs may also be used as NOUNS.

Examples: The **climb** to the top was difficult. / The **surge** in prices affected everyone.

USEFUL LANGUAGE FOR TASK 1 (WRITING)

GO UP – to move from a lower level to a higher level



★ These verbs may also be used as NOUNS.
Example: The rise in prices is reflected in the chart.

OTHER VERBS TO EXPRESS "GO UP"

1. **climb** – go up slowly or steadily
   Example: Sales climbed from 10 to 50 million.
2. **go up** – increase
   Example: The price of fuel went up.
3. **grow** – increase gradually
   Example: The population is growing.
4. **increase** – become greater in number or size
   Example: The sales increased every year.
5. **jump** – increase suddenly
   Example: Profits jumped to $5 million.
6. **rise** – increase steadily or sharply
   Example: The temperature rose quickly.
7. **rocket** – increase extremely quickly
   Example: Online sales rocketed last year.

- **Climb**
  Example: The sales of Product Y climbed steadily from 10 million in 2015 to 40 million in 2019.
- **Go up**
  Example: The sales of Product Y went up consistently throughout the period.

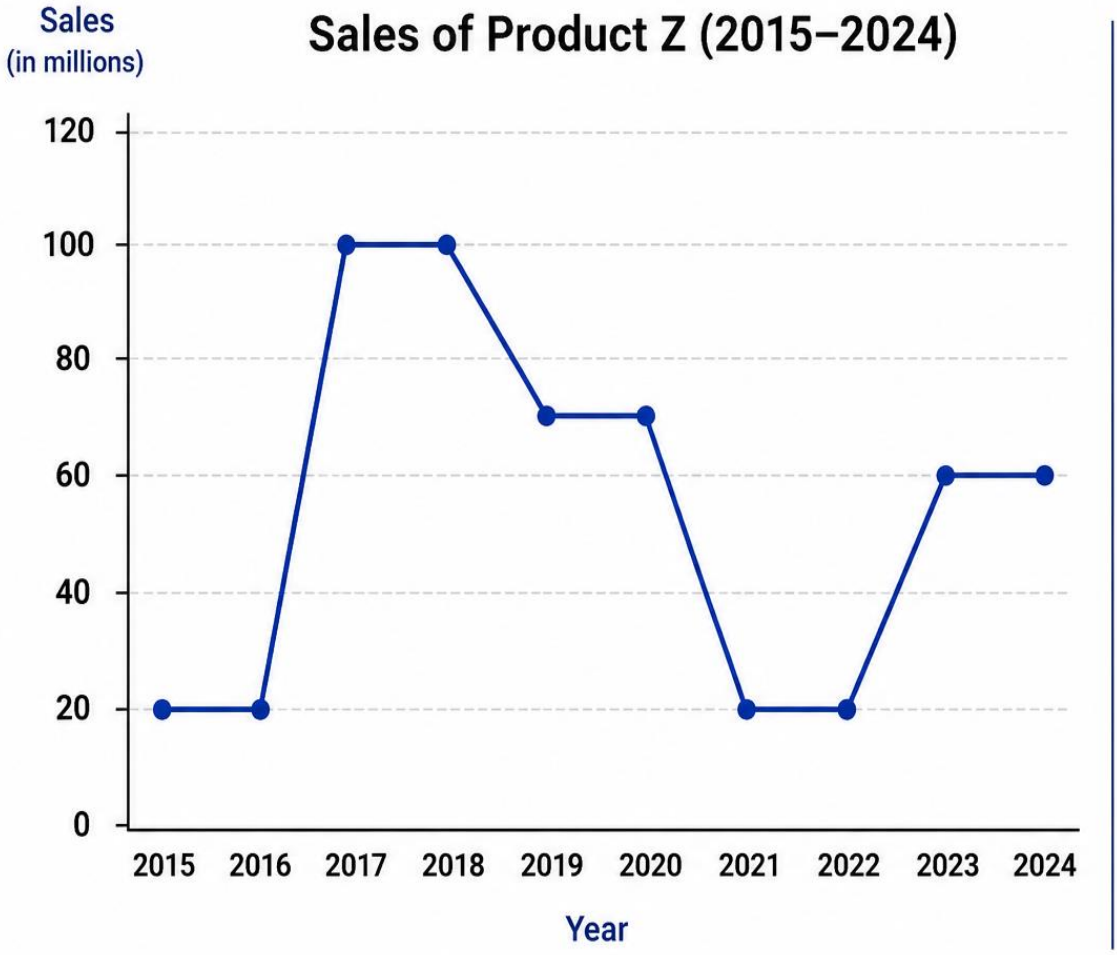
- **Grow**
  Example: The company's profits grew gradually between 2016 and 2021.
- **Increase**
  Example: The graph shows that sales increased from 20 million in 2017 to nearly 70 million in 2022.
- **Jump**
  Example: The sales jumped sharply from 70 million in 2022 to 85 million in 2023.
- **Rise**
  Example: The number of customers rose significantly over the ten-year period.
- **Rocket**
  Example: The sales rocketed to almost 95 million by 2024.

Using "Rocket" Correctly:

- **No Adverbs Needed:** Just like "plunge," the verb "**rocket**" should not be used with adverbs.

- **Built-in Meaning:** "**Rocketed**" already means "increased significantly" or "rose sharply".
- **Avoid Redundancy:** Since it already implies a massive or sharp increase, adding an adverb is unnecessary.

USEFUL LANGUAGE FOR TASK 1 (WRITING) – LEVEL OFF



NO CHANGE

1. remained stable
2. leveled off
3. stabilized
4. remained the same

- **Remained stable**

  Example: The sales remained stable at 20 million between 2015 and 2016.

- **Leveled off**

  Example: After a sharp increase, the sales leveled off at 100 million from 2017 to 2018.

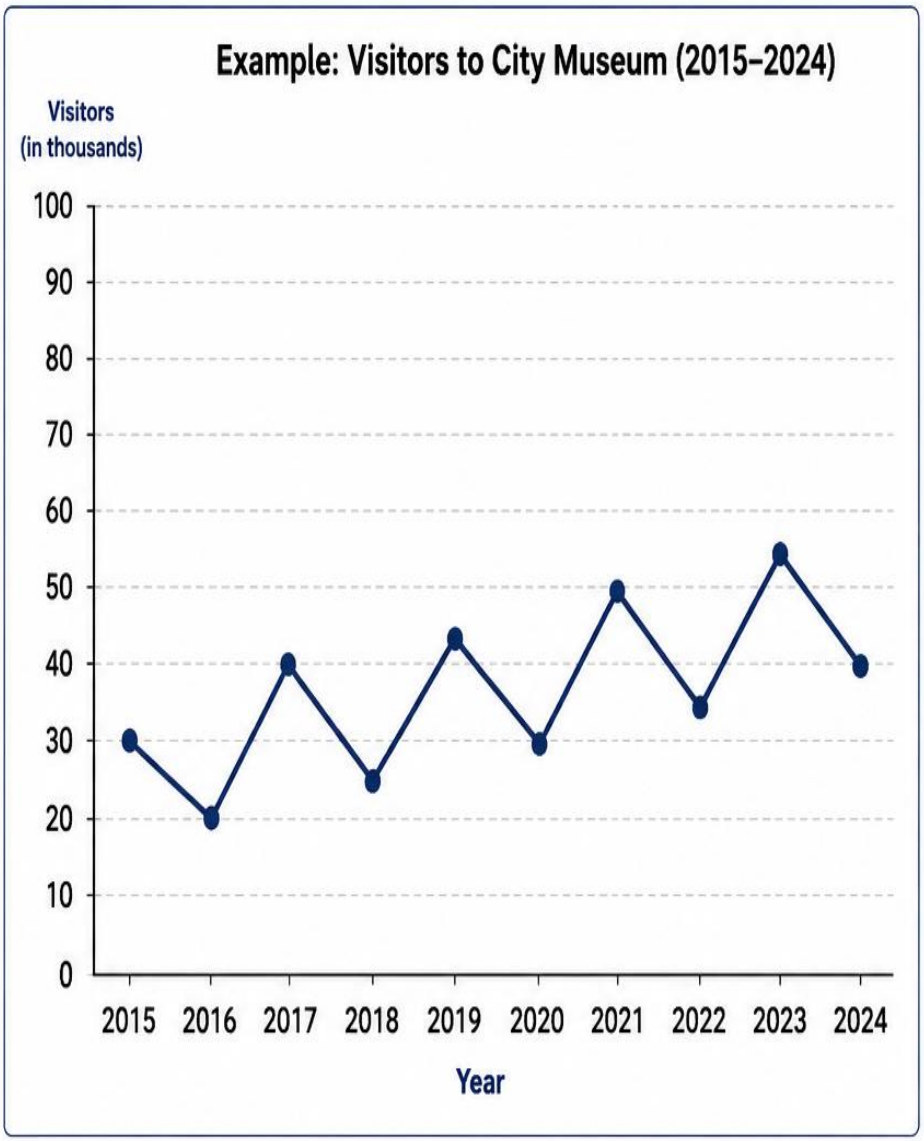
- **Stabilized**

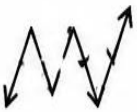
  Example: The figure stabilized at around 70 million between 2019 and 2020.

- **Remained the same**

  Example: "The sales remained the same at 60 million from 2023 to 2024."

USEFUL LANGUAGE FOR IELTS WRITING – CHANGE AND FLUCTUATION



VOCABULARY	MEANING	EXAMPLE
Fluctuate 	• to rise and fall irregularly • not steady	The number of visitors **fluctuated** throughout the period.
Vary 	• to change from one thing to another • to be different in amount or value	Visitors to the museum **varied** from year to year.
Go up and down 	• to increase and decrease repeatedly • to not move in one direction	The figures **went up and down** several times.
Rise and fall 	• to increase and then decrease • to move in both directions	The number of visitors **rose and fell** over the ten years.

EXAMPLES

- **Fluctuate**

  Example: The number of visitors fluctuated throughout the period, with no steady pattern.

- **Vary**

  Example: Visitor numbers varied from 20,000 to 55,000 over the ten years.

- **Go up and down**

  Example: The figures went up and down several times between 2015 and 2024.

- **Rise and fall**

  Example: The number of visitors rose and fell, reaching a high of 55,000 in 2023 and a low of 20,000 in 2016.

***Both **fluctuation** and **variation** can be used as nouns in IELTS Writing Task 1.

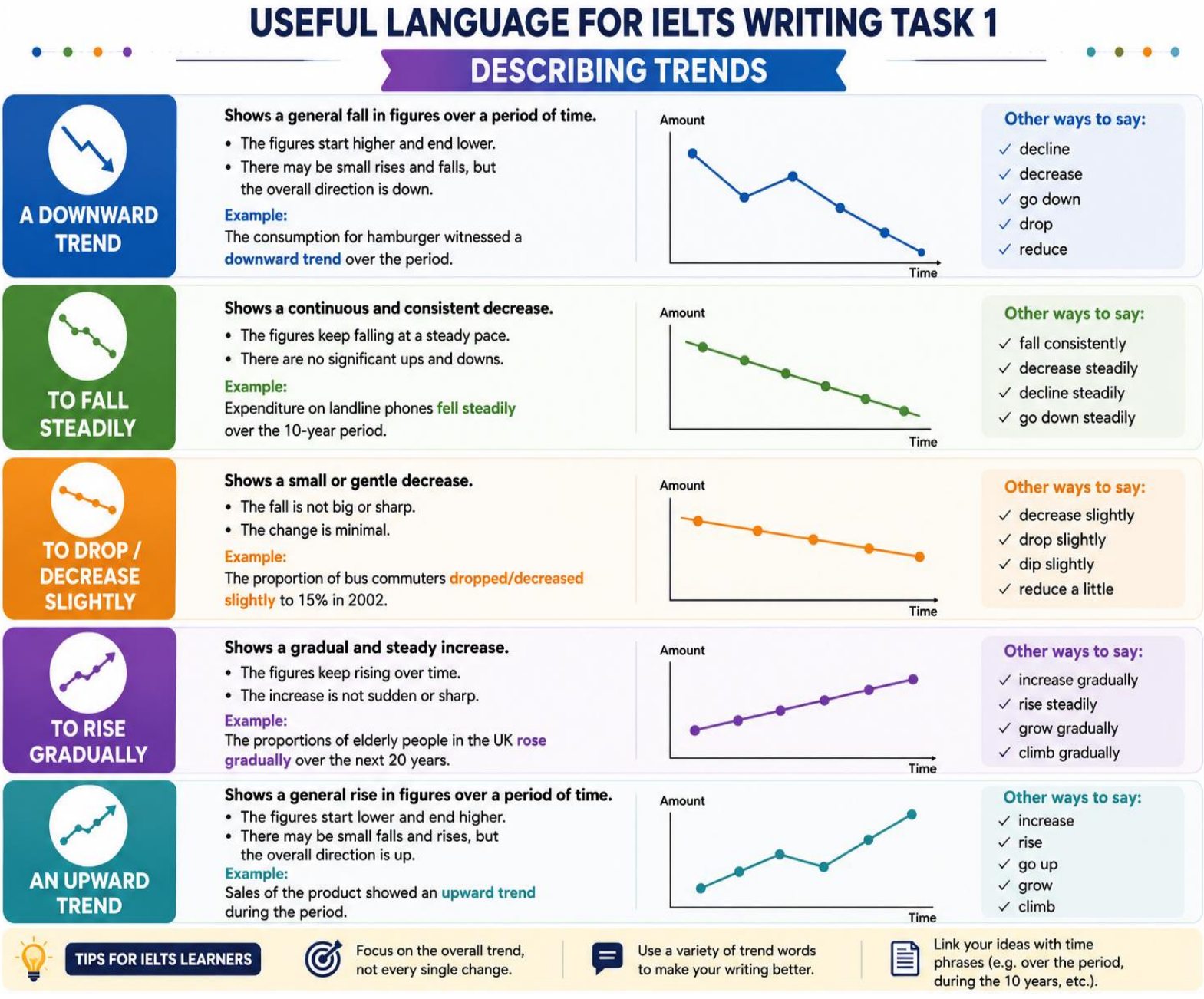
- **Fluctuation** *(Noun)*

  Example: There was a significant fluctuation in the number of visitors between 2015 and 2024.

Example: The graph shows fluctuations in visitor numbers throughout the period.

- **Variation** *(Noun)*
  Example: There was considerable variation in the number of tourists over the ten-year period.

Example: The chart illustrates variations in sales figures from year to year.



The Versatile Choice: "Stood at"

- **Usage**: You can use "**stood at**" anywhere on the graph—at the beginning, middle, or end.
- ***Example*:** The number of coffee sales **stood at** 25 million in 2010.

Starting Points

- **Usage**: Use "**started at**" or "**began at**" only for the very first data point on the graph.
- ***Example*:** "In 2000, the figure for Internet users **started at** approximately 50 million".

Ending Points

- **Usage**: Use "**ended at**" or "**finished at**" for the final data point on the timeline.
- *Example*: "The figure **finished at** over 50%".

Pro-Tip for Your App Users

IELTS Vocabulary Tip: Using a mix of "stood at" for middle points and

"started/finished at" for the ends will make your Writing Task 1 report sound more professional and varied. Avoid repeating the same verb too many times!

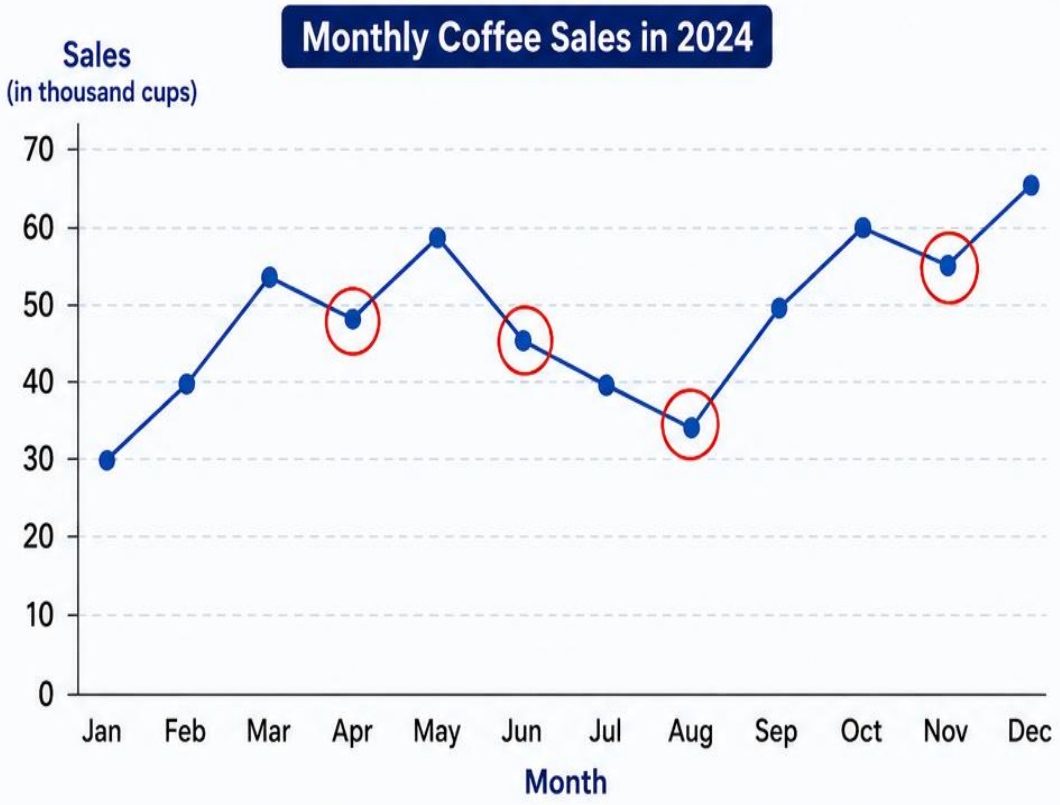
USEFUL LANGUAGE FOR IELTS WRITING TASK 1

DIPPED/DECREASED SLIGHTLY

Used to describe a **small fall** or a **slight reduction** in figures.

EXAMPLES

- *Expenditure on furniture dipped slightly from 9% to 7% between 2002 and 2005.*
- *Coffee sales decreased slightly between June and August.*



WHERE "DIP" IS APPLICABLE

"Dip" is used for a small fall or downward movement between two points.

○ Places where "dip" can be used

Other similar words:

- **Decrease slightly** – small fall
- **Drop slightly** – small fall
- **Dip** – small fall (usually short-term)
- **Reduce slightly** – small reduction

TIP FOR IELTS LEARNERS

Use "dipped/decreased slightly" when the change is small and not dramatic. It helps your writing sound accurate and natural.

General Overview Expressions

- Overall, it is clear that…
- Overall, it can be seen that…
- In general,…
- On the whole,…
- Broadly speaking,…
- It is evident that…
- It is noticeable that…
- It can be seen from the graph that…
- It is clear from the graph that…

Example: Overall, it is clear that sales of electric cars increased significantly, whereas petrol car sales declined over the same period.

Useful Time Expressions for IELTS Writing Task 1

General Time Expressions

- over the period
- throughout the period
- during the period
- over the ten-year period
- during the 20th century
- over the next few years

- from 2010 to 2020
- between 2005 and 2015
- during the period from 2010 to 2015
- during the years from 2010 to 2015
- between 2010 and 2015

Example:

Sales increased steadily **over the period.**

The population of the city increased significantly **during the period from 2000 to 2010**, reaching a peak of one million.

Starting Point

- at the beginning of the period
- initially
- at the start of the year
- in the first year
- at the beginning

Example:

Initially, the number of visitors was quite low.

Ending Point

- at the end of the period
- finally

- by the end of the year
- in the final year
- towards the end of the period

Example:

By the end of the period, sales had doubled.

Simultaneous Time Expressions

- meanwhile
- at the same time
- simultaneously
- during the same period

Example:

Meanwhile, unemployment rates declined steadily.

Sudden / Short Period

- suddenly
- abruptly
- in a short period of time
- within a few months
- overnight

Example:

Prices rose sharply within a few months.

Gradual / Long Period

- gradually
- steadily
- slowly
- over time
- little by little

Example:

The population grew gradually over time.

Specific Time Expressions

- in January
- in 2015
- in the early 2000s
- in the late 1990s
- by 2024
- until 2020
- after 2018
- before 2010

Example:

The figure remained stable until 2020.

Peak / Lowest Point

- reached a peak in
- peaked at
- hit a low in
- reached its lowest point in

Example:

Oil prices peaked at $80 in 2019.

Useful Combination Phrases

- from 2010 onwards
- over the following years
- during the first half of the year
- during the latter half of the period
- over the next decade
- between January and March

Example:

Exports increased significantly over the following years.

Language Of Estimation

- Just over
- Nearly
- About
- Around

- Almost
- Approximately
- Just about
- Very nearly
- More than
- Less than

Examples:

1. Just over 60% of students preferred online learning.
2. Approximately 500 people attended the event in 2020.

Synonyms:

. Average
. Mean

Examples

1. The average monthly income increased gradually over the period.
2. The mean temperature remained stable throughout the year.

Contrast / Comparison Words

. While

- Whereas
- Although
- Though
- Meanwhile

Examples:

1. Car sales increased, whereas bicycle sales declined.
2. While the population of City A grew rapidly, City B experienced only a slight rise.

Exactness Words

- Exactly
- Accurately
- Specifically

Examples:

1. Exactly 50% of participants preferred public transport.
2. The graph specifically illustrates changes in oil prices between 2010 and 2020.

Time Expressions Words

. In 2000
. During the year 2000
. In the year 2000

Examples:

1. In 2000, the unemployment rate stood at 8%.
2. During the year 2000, internet usage increased significantly.

Statistical / Graph Vocabulary

- Share
- Proportion
- Percentage
- Rate
- Fraction
- Ratio
- Portion

Examples:

1. “The proportion of female students rose steadily over the decade.”
2. “The percentage of online shoppers reached a peak in 2022.”

Useful Academic Expressions:

- Regarding
- With respect to
- In terms of
- In relation to
- With regard to

Examples:

1. With regard to education, government spending increased considerably.
2. In terms of population growth, Asia recorded the highest figures.

Synonyms of Categories

- Type
- Group
- Class
- Division
- Section

Examples:

1. “The products were divided into several categories.”
2. “The chart illustrates different types of transport used by people.”

Synonyms of Types

- Kinds
- Varieties
- Forms
- Classes
- Groups

Examples:

1. Different kinds of energy sources are shown in the graph.
2. The table compares various forms of communication.

Synonyms of Group

- Category
- Class
- Section
- Division
- Segment

Examples:

1. The largest group of consumers preferred online shopping.
2. The population was divided into different age groups.

Synonyms of Section

- Part
- Division
- Segment
- Category
- Portion

Examples:

1. The largest section of the pie chart represents food expenses.
2. One part of the graph shows a significant increase.

Synonyms of Viewer

Viewer – spectator/Watcher/Audience

***** 15-59 age group/Age group of 15 to 59 years/ people aged 15 to 59 years. (All are synonyms of each other.)**

USEFUL WORDS FOR PARAPHRASING A SUMMARY

Original Sentence

"The chart below shows…"

Paraphrased Sentence

- The line graph…
- The line chart…
- indicates…
- depicts…
- reveals…
- illustrates…

Examples:

1. The line graph illustrates changes in oil prices over the period.
2. The chart depicts the percentage of students using public transport.

Sales / Revenue Vocabulary

- Sales
- Income
- Revenue
- Turnover
- How much money was made

Example:

1. The company's revenue increased significantly between 2010 and 2020.
2. Total sales reached a peak in 2019.

Income Level Vocabulary

- The income rate
- The income level
- The level of income
- The rate of income
- The level of revenue
- The revenue rate
- The revenue level

Examples

1. The income level rose steadily throughout the decade.

2. The revenue rate declined slightly after 2018.

Place Paraphrasing

. New York City bookstore
. Bookstore in New York City

Examples

1. The bookstore in New York City recorded the highest sales.
2. New York City bookstores experienced a gradual increase in revenue.

Proportion Vocabulary

- Proportion
- Percentage
- Rate

Examples:

1. The percentage of female students increased steadily.
2. The unemployment rate remained stable during the period.

Figure Expressions

- The proportion of

- The percentage of
- The figure for

Examples:

1. The figure for online shopping rose sharply in 2020.
2. The percentage of elderly people increased gradually.

Time Expressions

. From 2000 to 2005
. Between 2000 and 2005
. Over a period of five years

Examples

1. Car sales increased between 2000 and 2005.
2. The population grew steadily over a period of five years.

Elderly Vocabulary

. The elderly
. Elderly people
. Senior citizens

Examples:

1. The proportion of senior citizens rose significantly.
2. Healthcare spending for the elderly increased gradually.

Spending Vocabulary

- Spending
- Expenditure

Examples:

1. Government expenditure on education increased considerably.
2. Consumer spending declined slightly after 2019.

Information Vocabulary

- Information
- Data

Examples:

1. The chart provides information about energy consumption.
2. The data illustrates changes in population growth.

Unemployment Vocabulary

. Levels of unemployment
. Unemployment rate

Examples

1. The unemployment rate fell steadily during the decade.
2. Levels of unemployment remained stable after 2015.

Poverty Vocabulary

. Poverty rate
. Level of poverty

Examples

1. The poverty rate decreased gradually over the years."
2. The level of poverty was highest in rural areas.

Production Vocabulary

- Production
- Manufacture
- Be produced
- Be made

- Be manufactured

Examples:

1. Most electronic products were manufactured in Asia.
2. Car production increased significantly after 2010.

Categories Vocabulary

- Categories
- Groups
- Classes
- Types
- Kinds

Examples:

1. The products were divided into several categories.
2. Different types of transport are shown in the chart.

Age Group Expressions

Examples:

1. People aged 15 to 59 formed the largest group.

2. The proportion of people aged over 60 increased steadily.

Audience Vocabulary

- Viewers
- Spectators
- Watchers
- Audience

Examples

1. The number of viewers increased dramatically after 2018.
2. The audience for online streaming services grew steadily.

Common Prepositions Used with IELTS Writing Task 1 Trend Vocabulary

✓ Increase

Common Structures

. increase **to**
. increase **by**
. increase **from … to**

Examples:

1. The number of students increased to 50% in 2020.
2. Sales increased by 20% over the period.
3. The figure increased from 50 to 80.

✓ Rise

Common Structures

- rise **to**
- rise **by**
- rise **from … to**

Examples:

1. The unemployment rate rose to 15% in 2015.
2. Oil prices rose by $10.
3. The percentage rose from 30% to 60%.

✓ Go Up

Common Structures

- go up **to**
- go up **by**
- go up **from … to**

Examples:

1. House prices went up to $500,000.

2. The figure went up by 5%.
3. Sales went up from 200 to 400 units.

✓ Fall

Common Structures

. fall **to**
. fall **by**
. fall **from … to**

Examples:

1. The number of visitors fell to 20 million.
2. The unemployment rate fell by 3%.
3. The figure fell from 80% to 45%.

• Drop

Common Structures

. drop **to**
. drop **by**
. drop **from … to**

Examples:

1. Car sales dropped to 10,000 units.
2. The rate dropped by 15%.

3. The figure dropped from 70% to 40%.

• Decline

Common Structures

. decline **to**
. decline **by**
. decline **from … to**

Examples:

1. The population declined to 2 million.
2. Exports declined by 10%.
3. The percentage declined from 60% to 35%.

Reach

In IELTS Writing Task 1, reach is usually used without a preposition before the number/value.

reach + number/value/point

Correct Examples:

- The population reached 2 million in 2020.
- Sales reached their highest point in 2019.
- The figure reached 75% by the end of the period.

- Oil prices reached a peak of $80.

Common Mistake ❌

- The figure reached to 50%.

Correct Form ☑

- The figure reached 50%.

Use of Verbs Without Preposition in Task 1

- reach
- approach
- exceed
- hit

Examples:

- The number hit 60% in 2022.
- Sales exceeded 1 million units.

Synonym of Use

In IELTS Writing Task 1, there is no single "perfect" synonym for the word **use** because the best choice depends entirely on **what** is being used in the chart, graph, or diagram.

To score a Band 7 or higher in Lexical Resource (vocabulary), you must use precise alternatives based on the context of the data.

1. For Energy, Water, and Food (Resource Data)

If your task involves charts tracking ***electricity, gas, oil, water, or food,*** these are your best options:

- **Consume:** This is the most natural and high-scoring substitute for resource usage.
  - *Instead of:* The amount of electricity **used…**
  - *Write:* The amount of electricity **consumed**...
- **Expend:** Excellent when referring to ***energy, effort, or financial budgets***.
  - *Instead of:* More energy was **used** on heating...
  - *Write:* More energy was **expended** on heating...

2. For Processes and Diagrams (Methods & Machinery)

If you are describing a manufacturing process or how a system works:

- **Utilize:** Best used when turning a raw material or a tool into something functional.
  - *Instead of:* "Limestone is **used** to make cement..."
  - *Write:* "Limestone is **utilized** to manufacture cement..."
- **Employ:** Ideal when referring to a specific method, technique, or workforce.
  - *Instead of:* "A different method was **used** in 2010..."
  - *Write:* "A different methodology was **employed** in 2010..."

3. For Natural Resources and Power Generation

If the graph shows a country generating power from natural elements:

- **Harness:** Specifically used for capturing and using natural forces ***(wind, solar, tidal power).***
  - *Instead of:* "Solar energy is **used** to create power..."
  - *Write:* "Solar energy is **harnessed** to generate electricity..."
- **Exploit:** To make full use of a natural resource.
  - *Instead of:* "The country **used** its oil reserves..."
  - *Write:* "The country **exploited** its oil reserves...

Tense Rules for IELTS Writing Task 1

1. When to Use Present Tense

Use present tense when:

- the graph shows current data
- the information is generally true
- the chart contains present/future information
- writing the introduction or overview

Common Words

- shows
- illustrates
- depicts
- indicates

Examples:

- The chart shows the percentage of online users in different countries.
- Overall, the graph indicates an upward trend.
- The current figure stands at 60%.

2. When to Use Past Tense

Use past tense when:

- all data is from the past
- years are finished (e.g., 1990–2010)

Common Verbs

- increased
- decreased
- rose
- fell
- declined

Examples:

- Sales increased significantly between 2000 and 2010.
- The unemployment rate fell gradually in 2005.
- Car ownership reached its peak in 2012.

3. When to Use Future Tense

Use future tense when:

- the graph contains predictions
- future years are shown
- estimated data is given

Common Structures

- will increase
- is expected to rise
- is predicted to decline
- is projected to grow

Examples

- The population will increase steadily by 2035.
- Oil consumption is predicted to decline in the future.

- “The figure is expected to reach 80% by 2030.”

4. When a Graph Has Past + Present + Future Data

Introduction → Present Tense

Example:

The line graph illustrates changes in population between 2000 and 2035.

Overview → Usually Present Tense

Example:

Overall, the graph shows a general upward trend.

Body Paragraphs → Use Time-Based Tense

Past Data

Sales increased between 2000 and 2010.

Present Data

The current figure stands at 50%.

Future Data

The rate is expected to rise significantly by 2035.

MAP VOCABULARY & USEFUL LANGUAGE

Introduction for Map Questions

Common Introduction Structures

- The maps illustrate…
- The maps show…
- The diagrams depict…
- The plans compare…
- The maps compare changes in…

Examples:

1. The maps illustrate changes in a town between 2000 and 2025.
2. The diagrams compare the layout of a city in 1990 and 2020."

Grammar for IELTS Maps

Use Passive Voice Most of the Time

Map questions usually focus on:

- construction
- demolition
- development
- relocation

So passive voice is very important.

Structure:

was/were + past participle

Examples:

- A new road was constructed.
- The old factory was demolished.
- Several trees were removed.

Tense for Map Questions

1. **Past Map → Past Tense**

Example:

A bridge was built in 2010.

2. **Present Map → Present Tense**

Example:

A park is located in the center of the town.

3. **Future Map / Proposed Plan → Future Tense**

Example:

A new shopping mall will be constructed near the river.

OR

A new stadium is planned to be built.

Language of Direction

1. **In the north of**
   (inside an area)

Example:

A school is located in the north of the city

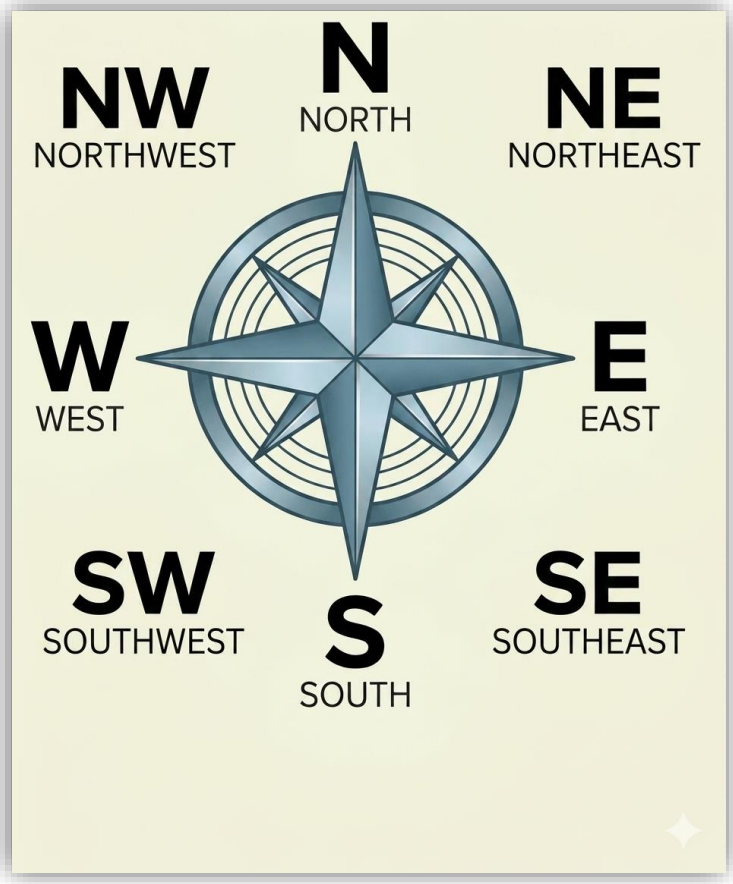
2. **To the north of**
   (outside/comparison)

Example:

The airport is situated to the north of the river.

Other Direction Vocabulary

- in the south of
- to the south of
- in the east of
- to the east of
- in the west of
- to the west of
- in the northeast of
- to the northeast of
- in the southwest of
- to the southwest of



Examples:

1. A residential area was built in the west of the town.
2. The forest is located to the east of the river.

Language of Location

Common Expressions

- be located
- be situated
- be positioned
- be placed

Examples:

1.The library is located near the river.

2. A café was situated next to the station.

Location Prepositions

Next to (very close to something**)**

Example:

A car park was constructed next to the hotel.

Opposite (Contrary, Reverse & Inverse**)**

Example:

A supermarket was built opposite the school.

Along (Alongside/Beside)

Example:

A road was constructed along the river.

Across from (On the opposite side of a street, road, room, table, or open space; directly facing something)

Example:

The park is located across from the hospital.

Between

Example:

A café was built between the bank and the cinema.

Behind

Example:

A parking area was added behind the shopping mall.

Near

Example:

A bridge was constructed near the residential area.

Around

Example:

Trees were planted around the lake.

Verbs to Describe Changes

Construction Verbs

- built
- constructed
- erected
- established
- installed

Examples:

A new bridge was constructed over the river.
Several street lights were installed near the road.

Removal Verbs

- demolished
- knocked down
- removed
- cleared

Examples

1. The old factory was demolished.
2. Several houses were removed to make way for a highway.”

Tree / Nature Vocabulary

- cut down
- chopped down
- uprooted

Examples

Many trees were cut down to build a car park.

The forest area was uprooted during the redevelopment.

Relocation Vocabulary

Words

- relocated
- moved
- transferred
- shifted

Examples:

1. The bus station was relocated to the south of the city.
2. The market was moved near the river.

Area & Zone Vocabulary

Urban Area = city area

Example:

The urban area expanded significantly.

Rural Area = countryside

Example:

The rural area remained unchanged.

Residential Area = housing area

Example:

A residential area was developed in the east.

Industrial Area = factory/manufacturing area

Example:

The industrial area was expanded near the port.

Commercial Area = business/shopping area

Example:

A commercial area was constructed beside the railway station.

Recreational Area = place for relaxation/fun

Examples:

- park
- playground
- sports center

Example:

A recreational area was added near the lake.

Entertainment Area = place for movies, shopping, games, restaurants

Example:

An entertainment area was developed in the city center.

Map Comparison Language

New Features

- was added
- was introduced
- was developed

Example:

A cycle lane was added beside the road.

Disappearance

- disappeared
- was removed

- no longer existed

Example:

The farmland disappeared after 2015.

No Change

- remained unchanged
- stayed the same
- remained stable

Example:

The river remained unchanged throughout the period.

A, An & The in Map Writing

Use “a”

before consonant sounds.

Examples

- a park
- a bridge
- a hospital

Example Sentence:

A bridge was constructed over the river.

Use “an”

before vowel sounds.

Examples

- an airport
- an industrial area
- an entertainment center

Example Sentence:

An airport was built to the north of the town.

***[Use a/an for something new:

Example: The warehouse was replaced by **a** playground (It is new).]

Use "the"

when the place is specific or already known.

Examples

- the river
- the school
- the town center

Example Sentence:

The school was relocated near the river.

(**Note:** When a landmark remains unchanged ***from the old map to the new map***, it earns the definite article "the" because the examiner already knows which one you mean!

Old Map: A harbor New Map: Same harbor Your Essay: The harbor remained unchanged in the city center.)

Useful Linking Words

- while
- whereas
- meanwhile
- however
- in contrast
- overall

Example:

While the residential area expanded, the forest area decreased.

Overview Sentences for Maps

Examples

1. Overall, the town became more urbanized over the period.
2. Overall, significant changes took place, including the construction of new roads and residential areas.

3. Overall, the area experienced considerable development between 2000 and 2025."

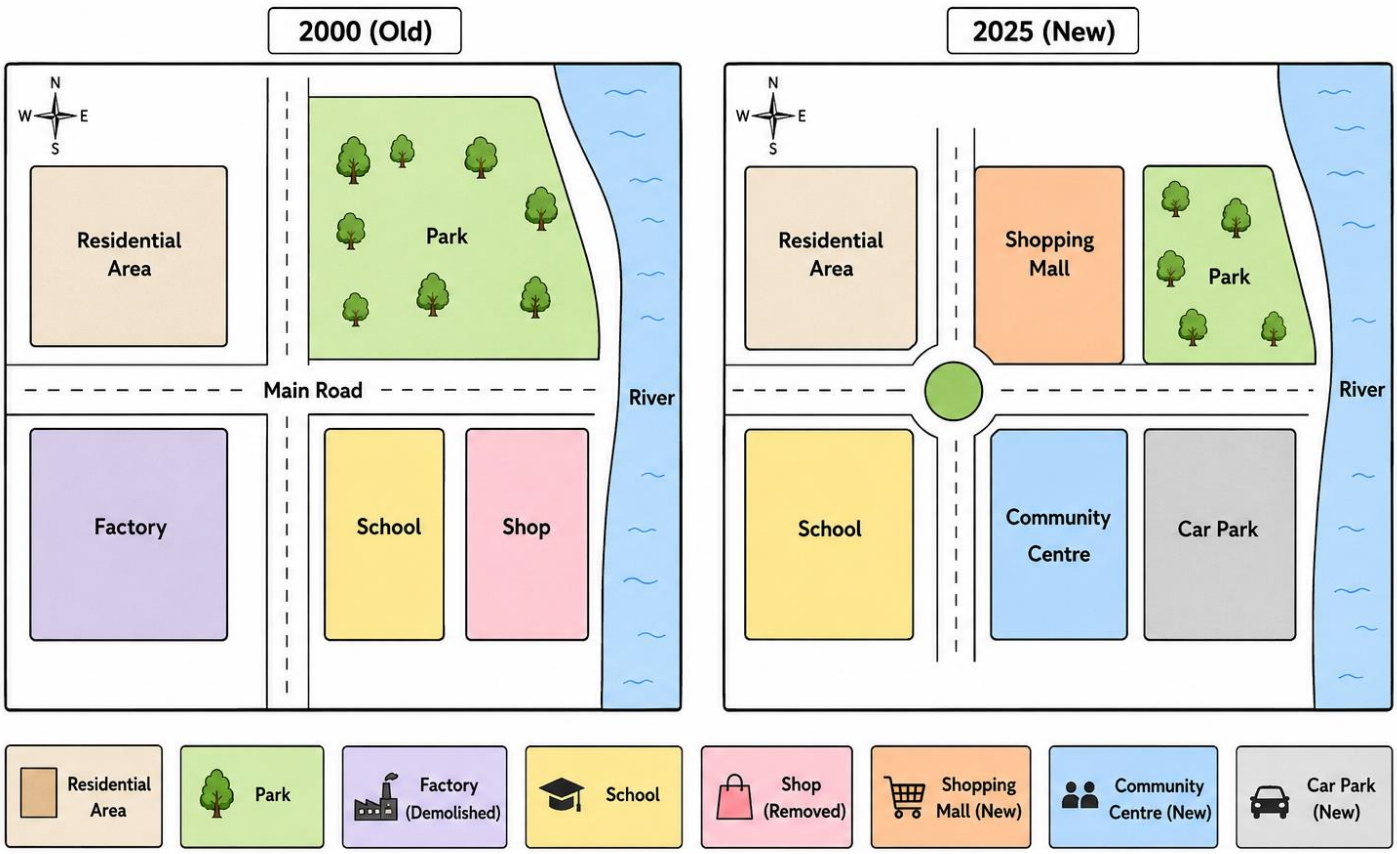
Band 7+ Strategies for IELTS Map Questions

- ☑ **Use passive voice**
- ☑ **Mention directions correctly**
- ☑ **Compare old and new maps**
- ☑ **Describe major changes only**
- ☑ **Use location prepositions accurately**
- ☑ **Write a clear overview**
- ☑ **Use map vocabulary naturally**

Important:

Do NOT describe every small detail. Focus on major developments and changes.

The maps below show the layout of a town in 2000 and the same town in 2025 after redevelopment.



1. Introduction

The maps illustrate the changes that took place in a town between 2000 and 2025 after a period of redevelopment.

2. Overview

Overall, the town experienced significant development over the 25-year period. The most

noticeable changes were the demolition of the factory and the removal of the shop, which were replaced by a community centre and a car park. In addition, a shopping mall and a roundabout were constructed, while the residential area, park and river largely remained unchanged.

3. Body Paragraph 1

In 2000, the town had a relatively simple layout. In the northwest, there was a residential area, while a large park occupied the northeast beside the river. A main road ran horizontally through the centre of the town, intersecting with another road leading northwards. In the southern part of the town, a factory was located in the southwest, whereas a school and a shop were situated in the southeast near the river.

4. Body Paragraph 2

By 2025, considerable changes had taken place in the town. The factory in the southwest was demolished and replaced by a larger school. The shop in the southeast was removed to make way for a car park. Moreover, a new community centre was constructed in the south-central area. In the north, a shopping mall was built between the residential area and the park. Another major development was the construction of a roundabout at the intersection of the two roads, which improved transportation within the town.


IELTS
is not just a test,
it's your FUTURE.
STUDY ABROAD
GLOBAL OPPORTUNITIES
BETTER FUTURE
TODAY'S PLAN:
LISTEN
READ
WRITE
SPEAK
ONE STEP CLOSER TO YOUR DREAM.
Don't stop when it's hard, stop when you're PROUD.
IELTS ACADEMIC
IELTS READING
IELTS WRITING
IELTS LISTENING
IELTS SPEAKING
FOCUS
DISCIPLINE
CONSISTENCY
SUCCESS
PATIENCE TODAY, SUCCESS TOMORROW.
EXCUSES DON'T GET DREAMS. EFFORT DOES.
You are stronger than you think.
KEEP GOING!
PREPARE TODAY, ACHIEVE TOMORROW.